



Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

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### Let's Start!

Let's learn about the Day of the Dead!



#### Learning Outcome:

Accurately use information about travel and vacations in social situations.

#### Can Do Statements:

- I can talk about celebrations and traditions.
- I can make suggestions.
- I can give orders and/or instructions.

#### Ask your partner:

- Do you know about the Day of the Dead?
- Where does this holiday take place?
- What do people do at that time?
- Do you want to participate? Why or why not?





## Let's Explore!

John is reading a brochure about the Day of \*the Dead.

\*Dead can be a noun or an adjective. "The Dead" (noun) means the people who are "dead" (adjective).



*Instructions: Read the brochure.*

The Day of the Dead is a traditional Mexican holiday. For two days every year, Mexican families honor their dead relatives and friends.

It is not a sad day. It is a time of remembering and happiness. During this holiday, families go to the cemeteries to decorate the graves with fruit, candles, bread, chocolates and flowers. They play music, tell stories about the dead and even have picnics in the cemeteries.

Get ready to celebrate! Why don't you bring the whole family for a day of activities in preparation for the Day of the Dead? Take part in classes in bread-baking, storytelling and crafts. Enjoy dance and musical performances and traditional music. There's something for everyone. It's a great way to learn about Mexican culture!





## Let's Practice!

The brochure makes suggestions about how to enjoy the Day of the Dead.

*Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Write each word in the correct order.*

the day Why activities you for whole a don't bring family of ?

part classes You take in can storytelling . \_\_\_\_\_

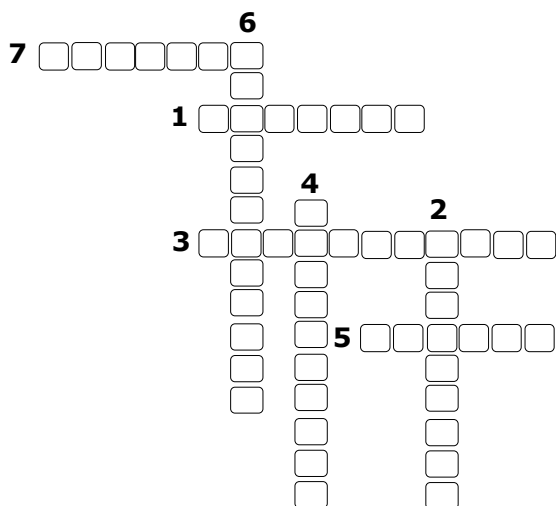
enjoy performances could dance you . \_\_\_\_\_



## Let's Practice!

What do you know about the Day of the Dead?

*Instructions: Complete the crossword.*



### Down

2. Mexican families honor their dead \_\_\_\_\_ and friends.
4. Families go to the \_\_\_\_\_.
6. There are classes in bread-baking. \_\_\_\_\_ and crafts.

### Across

1. The day of the dead is a traditional Mexican \_\_\_\_\_.
3. It is a time of \_\_\_\_\_ and happiness.
5. They decorate the \_\_\_\_\_ with fruit, candles, bread, chocolates and flowers.
7. They play music, tell stories and even have \_\_\_\_\_.





## Extension Activity

Invent your own holiday.

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Choose something NEW you would like to celebrate, like a special time in your life, a discovery, etc.
- Invent a name for your new holiday.
- Write sentences about the holiday. Say when it takes place, explain the purpose, and describe what people can do to celebrate.
- Proofread your sentences. Make sure you use capital letters and punctuation correctly.
- Read your sentences to a teacher or classmate.

### Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about traditions and celebrations.

☐☐

I create an name for a new holiday.

☐☐

I make suggestions.

☐☐

I write complete statements and read my proposal to a partner.

☐☐

## Target Words

- **remembering** (noun): the action of thinking about people or events from the past  
e.g. The Day of the Dead is a time of remembering.
- **happiness** (noun): the feeling of being happy  
e.g. It is also a time for happiness.
- **dead** (noun): people who are no longer living  
e.g. The Day of the Dead is a traditional Mexican holiday.
- **cemetery** (noun): the area where dead people are buried  
e.g. During this holiday, families go to the cemeteries.
- **grave** (noun): the specific place where a dead person is buried  
e.g. People decorate the graves with flowers.
- **candle** (noun): a stick made of wax with a string that burns slowly  
e.g. People take candles to decorate the graves.
- **picnic** (noun): eating a meal outside  
e.g. People tell stories and have picnics in the cemeteries.
- **storytelling** (noun): saying a story aloud to others  
e.g. Take part in classes in bread-baking, storytelling and crafts.



## Learning Points

### Festival vs. Holiday vs. Vacation - Nouns to Talk About Traditions

#### Holiday:

Holiday is a contraction of the words holy and day. They are special religious days.

- Most holidays are based on religion, like *Christmas*.
- Non-religious holidays can be national or international, like *American Independence Day*.

#### Festival:

A festival is a community event. Festivals can have religious origins, or have some cultural importance. They can also celebrate something about the natural world.

#### Vacation:

A vacation is a period of recreation or rest, away from work. You can sometimes spend your vacation time away from home.